

Lesson 11

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How to write

Supporting &

Concluding

Sentences

Concluding Sentences

How to end a paragraph

The final sentence of a paragraph is called the *concluding sentence*. It sums up the main points or restates the main idea in a different way. A sentence that sums up the paragraph reminds the reader of what the writer's main idea and supporting points were. A sentence that restates the main idea should give the same information in a slightly different way, perhaps by using different words or by using different word order. A concluding sentence should not introduce a new point.

Parts of a Paragraph: The Concluding Sentence

In addition to a topic sentence and body, a good paragraph has a **concluding sentence**.

The concluding sentence:

- ends the paragraph with a final thought
- often expresses the same idea as the topic sentence using different words
- does not give any new information about the topic

Look at the topic sentences and concluding sentences from a few paragraphs in this unit. Notice how they express the same ideas in different ways. Words that are important to the topic may be repeated.

TOPIC SENTENCE	CONCLUDING SENTENCE
My <u>back porch</u> is my <u>favorite place to relax</u> .	I can <u>relax</u> in many places, but my <u>back porch</u> is the best.
The <u>Shanghai Tower</u> is an <u>amazing building</u> .	The <u>Shanghai Tower</u> is <u>amazing</u> inside and out.
I have a <u>dream to visit Alaska</u> .	I really <u>want to visit</u> this wonderful <u>state</u> soon.

Buying a Car

Buying a car requires **careful** planning. First, you must decide to buy a new or a used car. New cars can be expensive, but they are reliable. Used cars are cheaper, but they often need repairs. You must also decide on what type of car to buy. You can research different types of cars on the Internet to help you choose. The final decision is where to buy your car. Some places charge you more money than others.

- a. It is important to think about all of these things when you are buying a car.
- b. The most important thing is the kind of car that you want to buy.
- c. You can buy your new car from a friend or a car dealer.

Hanami

Hanami, or flower viewing, is a popular Japanese tradition. Every spring, thousands of cherry trees bloom all over Japan. For two weeks during Hanami, friends and families gather in parks and the countryside to see the beautiful flowers and **celebrate** the beginning of spring. People make a lot of food and have picnics under the trees. There is a lot of music and dancing, and large groups of people walk through the parks together. The celebrations often go into the night.

- a. People like to be with their family and friends during Hanami.
- b. Looking at flowers during Hanami is interesting.
- c. Hanami is a Japanese custom many people love.

Mondays

I hate Mondays for many reasons. One reason is work. I get up early to go to work on Mondays. After a weekend of fun and relaxation, I do not like to do this. Another reason that I do not like Mondays is that I have three meetings every Monday. These meetings last a long time, and they are extremely boring. Traffic is also a big problem on Mondays. There are more cars on the road on Mondays. Drivers are in a hurry, and I must be more careful than usual when I drive.

- a. Mondays are worse than Tuesdays, but they are better than Sundays.
- b. I do not like meetings on Mondays.
- c. These are just a few reasons why I do not like Mondays

ACTIVITY 16 | Analyzing concluding sentences

Write the topic sentence and concluding sentence from each paragraph indicated. Then underline the similar information. Discuss your answers with a partner.

1. Paragraph 2.3

Topic sentence: _____

Concluding sentence: _____

2. Paragraph 2.4

Topic sentence: _____

Concluding sentence: _____

3. Paragraph 2.5

Topic sentence: _____

Concluding sentence: _____

Write an original paragraph. Follow the instructions.

- Answer the questions in the chart below. Use complete sentences or notes.
- Use at least two vocabulary words or phrases from the unit.
- Copy your sentences into paragraph form on a separate piece of paper. Underline vocabulary from the unit.
- Give your paragraph a title.

Topic Sentence	1. Who is the most interesting person you know? (This is your topic sentence.) <u>The most interesting person I know is</u>
Body	2. Why is this person interesting? List three reasons. Give an example to support each reason. Use adjectives in your descriptions. (These are your supporting sentences.) Reason 1: _____ Example 1: _____ Reason 2: _____ Example 2: _____ Reason 3: _____ Example 3: _____
Concluding Sentence	3. Write a concluding sentence that gives information similar to the information in your topic sentence. Use an adjective other than <i>interesting</i>. _____



Extra Practice

A. Write concluding sentences by reading the thesis statements and rewriting them so that the language is new but the ideas are unchanged. Begin each concluding sentence with an appropriate transition.

1. Children today do not have enough free unstructured playtime.

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2. Crime is a serious social problem that has a number of key causes.

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3. Mass tourism can bring about a number of negative effects.

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4. Despite its problems, globalization has been, in some ways, a beneficial phenomenon.

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5. Advertising targeted at children should be more tightly regulated.

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6. Governments should make entry to museums and art galleries free to the public.

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7. There are a number of actions that companies can take to increase staff motivation.

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8. There are some important planning considerations for those wanting to start a new business.

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